

job—you're probably smart to stay where you are. But look down the road a few years. Circumstances change. Chances are that the Peggy Lee Syndrome will pop up sooner or later. Even if you skate through executive crisis, you'll probably retire *someday*. And when you do, you'll want your new retired life to be as fun and exciting as the old.

LIFE AFTER WORK

This chapter's second rule is:

Enjoy your career and then move on

I look back on my work years with pride. I gained confidence and insight. I played the game and won my share. That success makes me one up on the playboy who inherited his wealth. I can go to the luncheon club, look at the guy across the table, and know I can do what he's doing. I've already done it. The only difference between him and me is the number of years of play.

After twelve years of work I had a good income and a full complement of executive trappings. I met with big people about big deals involving big bucks. But as the song in *A Chorus Line* goes, "that ain't it, kid." I wasn't getting many jollies at the office. New experiences were fewer and farther between. Old challenges suddenly became chores. The next move up was years away. Problems seemed stupid rather than interesting. I felt I was slugging away just to keep even. I saw myself trudging rather than skipping down the hall to the office.

A wealthy chief executive I know puts it this way: "If you don't have people dumping on you *all the time*, you're not far enough along in your career. People don't dump on the poor." When I first heard that, several years ago, I decided I could tough it out with the best of them. But as I thought about it in 1984, I figured I had been dumped on long enough. There *had* to be a better way.